

The Edge of the Pool: answers

Year 3 · 11 marks. Accept any sensible answer that is backed up by the text.

1. Miss Patel (1 mark)

Finding information (2b). A name to find in the second paragraph.

2. Jamal (1 mark)

Finding information (2b). Finding who did something is a basic retrieval skill: the child scans the text for the right name.

3. wobbly (1 mark)

Word meaning (2a). Finding the word that describes a feeling in the body.

4. Nervous or scared. Evidence, for example: “gripping his towel”, “did not move”, “knees felt wobbly”, “fluttering butterflies”. (2 marks)

Inference (2d). The story never says “Sam was scared”, so the child reads the clues and backs the idea up from the text.

5. No. It describes the fluttery, jumpy feeling people get when they are nervous. (2 marks)

Language choices. Understanding figurative language, not just spotting it.

6. Jamal’s thumbs up and encouragement (accept: taking a deep breath). (1 mark)

Explaining from the text. Linking a cause to what happened next.

7. Any one of: he was floating on his back, he had a huge smile, he said “Yes, please!” (1 mark)

Inference (2d). Another feeling to work out, this time from what Sam does and says.

8. 1. Sam stands at the edge. 2. Jamal gives a thumbs up. 3. Sam slides into the water. 4. Sam floats on his back. (2 marks)

Sequencing events. Sequencing shows the child has followed the whole story.